

Chapter 32-6

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Liang Shi and Zhao Ying's scenes were in the afternoon.

Lunch was crew box lunches, and this crew's food wasn't bad—three dishes and a soup.

Liang Shi rarely came to film sets, so she was happy and took a photo of the box lunch to post on her social media.

Then not long after, Zhao Xuning commented: [This is that pig slop from the crew?]

Liang Shi: ...

Liang Shi: Well said, please don't say it again next time.

When she switched back to the chat interface, she found that Zhao Xuning had sent her a screenshot.

The contact was labeled as Zhao Ying, who had also posted on social media—the same box lunch with the caption: Even pigs wouldn't eat this.

Liang Shi: "..."

She actually thought it tasted pretty good.

But she tentatively asked Zhao Xuning, [Can you give me your cousin's WeChat?]

Zhao Xuning: [Aren't you together?]

Liang Shi: [Too many people on set, asking for WeChat would look like I'm hitting on her.]

Zhao Xuning: [...]

Liang Shi: [After all, I have a wife, I need to stay faithful.]

Zhao Xuning: [...?]

After a while, someone actively added Liang Shi as a friend.

The profile picture was identical to the one in Zhao Xuning's screenshot.

Liang Shi immediately accepted and sent a well-behaved emoji, [Hello, Sister Ying.]

Zhao Ying: [Hello there, act well this afternoon.]

Liang Shi: [I will!]

After adding Zhao Ying on WeChat, she received another new message—a transfer from Liang Xinhe for 200,000 yuan.

Liang Shi: "..."

Liang Xinhe: [Our family isn't so poor that we'd make you eat pig slop.]

Liang Shi: [Second Brother, the crew lunch is pretty good.]

Liang Xinhe: [...Just looking at it kills my appetite.]

Liang Shi sent six dots.

She didn't understand the world of the wealthy.

She was used to staying on film sets. Although she could normally have good food, on sets it was basically like this.

Some actors did make special demands, but Liang Shi never did—she always ate the same box lunches as the extras.

Box lunches weren't about taste—they were about efficiency. Eat quickly, rest, and be ready for the next scene.

If you wanted good food and sleep, there weren't such conditions.

However, Liang Shi didn't transfer the 200,000 back. She kept it in her account for future emergencies, or to return to Liang Xinhe when he needed it.

The afternoon shoot was with Zhao Ying.

When researching Zhao Ying before, Liang Shi had found that Zhao Ying was famously obsessed with acting—everything served the performance.

She had played courtesans and generals, housewives and career women, high school students and other people's mothers. So Zhao Ying had an excellent reputation in the industry.

Moreover, her acting was superb, and there weren't many people in the industry who could match her performance.

Liang Shi was also nervous before filming, but Zhao Ying said, "Little sister, don't be afraid, I'll hold back a bit."

She was being very considerate.

But Liang Shi smiled and said, "Sister Ying, let's try once first. You should still use your full strength to act, and I'll see how I need to adjust."

Along with nervousness came anticipation.

She had watched Zhao Ying's cuts online, and every segment had strong emotional impact. She was very much looking forward to what it would feel like to act opposite such a person.

In Liang Shi's previous entertainment industry, her acting was also considered quite good, but she was young after all and still needed the tempering of years.

However, she was already a typical example of natural talent.

Acting opposite Zhao Ying now, she indeed couldn't keep up the first time.

But by the second time, she had gradually found her rhythm.

By the third time, she could match Zhao Ying evenly, though there were still differences in subtle details.

For good actors, a tiny difference could mean a world of difference.

On the third take, this shot was completed.

In the following scenes, Liang Shi had already adapted to Zhao Ying's acting rhythm, keeping up with her pace, and almost every scene was completed in one take.

This stunned everyone present.

Crew members couldn't help but whisper, "I remember the last actress of similar age who could act opposite Sister Ying like this was Yang Shuyan¹."

"This is incredible, more exciting than watching edited clips on video sites."

"When this airs, it'll be explosive."

"I've heard of natural talent, but I've never seen someone being force-fed by heaven itself."

"I can only say there are differences between people."

"Both were guided by Sister Ying, but Chen Liuying is still the same after four months, while this one can act opposite Sister Ying after less than half a day."

"I'm really impressed. I want to see them in a period drama about enemies-to-lovers, dual female leads playing villains."

"I already have the image in my head."

"Add Yang Shuyan too—the kind you'd click to watch just from one look."

"..."

Everyone was discussing enthusiastically, but Liang Shi just felt exhilarated.

Acting opposite someone like Zhao Ying, a method actor, was a joyful thing.

Even though she still had shortcomings, it was thoroughly satisfying.

Zhao Ying felt the same.

After the director called cut, Zhao Ying took several minutes to come out of character. Once she did, she said to Liang Shi, "Little sister, next time I have work, I'll call you."

Liang Shi: "..."

She smiled and readily agreed, "Deal!"

Footnotes:

¹ Yang Shuyan: A fictional actress name mentioned as a comparison point for skilled acting